

THE VIEW FROM ABOVE

Camera footage linked the mobile relay to a compact quadcopter leaving a secured roof. The aircraft was later recovered after failing to return.

Its route and purpose were concealed behind damaged storage and unfamiliar flight records. Investigators had to determine what the aircraft attempted and where it actually travelled.



Analysis separated two distinct phases of the flight and showed that the final position did not explain the mission. What appeared to be a simple failure was only the last event.

A second trail continued on the ground. Something that looked accidental had been placed with care.

The ground trail passed through an innocent employee and into a protected office. Nothing about the moment appeared unusual to the people nearby.

By the time investigators understood its connection to the flight, the next stage of the operation had already begun.



The recovered records closed the last gap in the timeline. The aircraft and the later activity were not separate incidents, although the connection had been designed to disappear.

The aerial operation had opened the first door into DIOGENES. Holmes now knew where Moriarty intended the trail to end.

THE ROSTER

When the fragments were viewed together, the campaign finally showed a structure. Each handoff had preserved distance between the people who acted and those who chose the targets.

Mycroft gave the operation an internal name and kept it away from the case files. At last, the threat had a shape.



Some participants dealt only with victims. Others handled access or movement. Their boundaries overlapped just long enough to pass the next task forward.

No branch held the complete plan. Every person received enough information to act and too little to explain the design.



The participants remained separated by disposable intermediaries and temporary infrastructure. Even successful operations revealed only the nearest connection.

A single arrest, broken server, or recovered device could expose one fragment, never the whole board. Moriarty had built survival into the distance between them.



Some codenames came from old enemies. Others existed only to provoke Holmes. Each operator saw enough to finish one task.

Behind them, Moriarty arranged the board. Watson studied the white knight and understood: *every piece required a hand to move it.*

THE FIRST WRONG ANSWER

After the recovered object was connected, Eleanor Mercer noticed an unexplained outbound session from a protected workstation. It matched no approved software.

The activity continued after the object was removed. Mercer preserved the workstation before anyone touched it.



The first activity resembled routine administration. The operator appeared to be learning the environment before attempting anything louder.

Its purpose remained unknown. Nothing yet explained how one quiet event could threaten the wider system or which record would prove the path.



Soon afterward, another unexplained event appeared deeper inside the protected environment. It looked valid and was entirely wrong.

Investigators could not yet explain how the two moments connected. They knew only that the incident had moved beyond its apparent starting point.



A repeated operator mark appeared beside the later activity. The pattern was patient and deliberate, but the route remained unproven.

Holmes refused to name a method before the evidence supported it. The next Sherlock would have to reconstruct the movement from the records.



DIOGENES

The investigation moved from one compromised workstation into a protected government network. Records from several systems conflicted, and no single timeline explained the intrusion.

Investigators had to establish the first foothold, sequence of access, and path toward the protected core without mistaking ordinary administration for hostile action.



POST-SOLVE CONTENT HIDDEN
REVEAL AFTER SHERLOCK